USER EVALUATION

CLAUSEGUARD

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Three questions we asked

Usability

Can first-time users finish the core tasks without help?

(Check a lease, judge its risk, find a problem, email the landlord, save a report.)

Understanding

Do people without legal knowledge see why a clause is a problem?

(Do they reach the right decision about signing?)

Trust and adoption

Would they trust it and use it before signing?

(Automated clause checkers are usually judged on accuracy alone, not on whether people understand the result.)

Four methods, run in sequence

1 · Predict

Cognitive walkthrough

The team, as persona Priya (22, first-time renter), stepped through 6 core tasks.

2 · Inspect

Expert review

External reviewers checked Nielsen’s 10 heuristics, severity 0–4

3 · Observe

Usability test

4 participants, a Dublin flat scenario, 7 goal-based tasks, thinking aloud.

4 · Measure

Survey

25 participants, task-based Google Form on the live site.

Who took part

25

survey participants

12 aged 24 or under, 7 aged 25–29, 6 aged 30+

13

had never signed an Irish lease

12 had, so we could compare the two groups

A small, young, self-selected sample: it represents student renters better than renters in general.

Usability test: 21 of 28 tasks done unaided

Task	Success	Median time	Ease (1–7)
1. Sign up / log in	3 of 4	0:50	6
2. Check the lease	4 of 4	1:18	5.5
3. Is it safe to sign?	4 of 4	3:10	5
4. Deposit problem	2 of 4	4:42	4.3
5. What the colours mean	4 of 4	0:58	6.3
6. Message the landlord	1 of 4	2:15	2.8
7. Save a copy (PDF)	3 of 4	2:31	5.5

Weakest: landlord email

In 3 of 4 sessions the draft kept loading, with no error message.

Right decision: 4 of 4

All decided not to sign

Survey: clear, trusted, and people would use it

84%

would use it before their next lease(21 out of 25)

4.6

explanations are clear out of 5

4.2

understand why a clause was flagged out of 5

4.1

trust in the analysis out of 5

But only 64% found the wait acceptable (Q5), and 60% said the chatbot felt like a helpful advisor (Q10).

ClauseGuard · User evaluation

Survey of 25 participants · 11 Nov 2026 to 12 Nov 2026 · ratings use a 1-5 scale (5 = best)

Participants	Would use it before their next lease (Q14)	Trust in the legal analysis (Q13)	Plain-English explanation is clear (Q6)	Understand why a clause breaks RTB rules (Q7)	Raised at least one issue (free text)
25	**84%**	**4.1** / 5	**4.6** / 5	**4.2** / 5	**10**
Google Form responses	21 said Yes	Average rating	Average rating	Average rating	people, grouped by hand

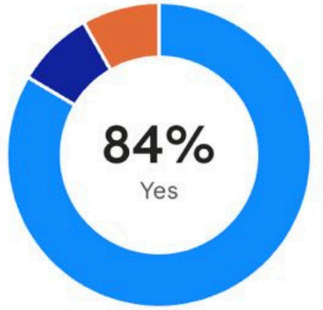
Average rating by question

1-5, 5 = best



Would you use it before your next lease?

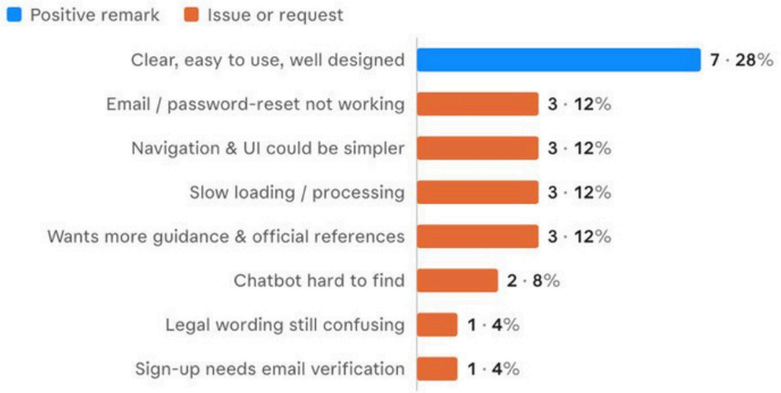
Q14



Yes	21 · 84%
Maybe	2 · 8%
No	2 · 8%

What people mentioned in free-text answers

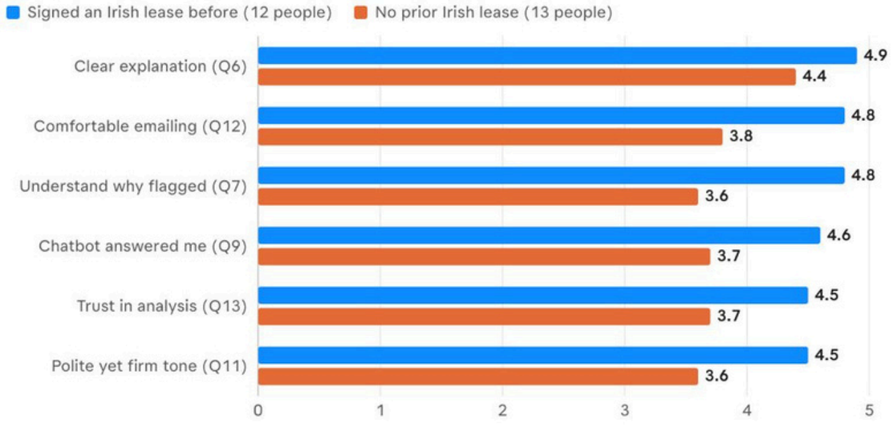
people per theme



Source: Google Form responses (anonymised), 25 participants. Shares are of all participants and are rounded. Feedback themes were grouped by hand from the free-text answers. A small, self-selected sample: read differences between small groups as indications only.

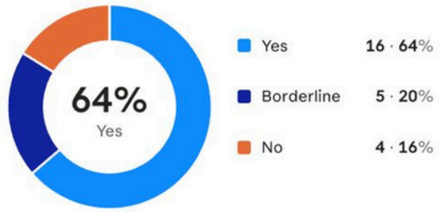
Average rating: signed an Irish lease before vs not

Q1



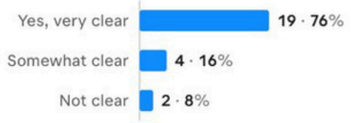
Was the wait time acceptable?

Q5



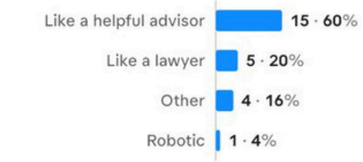
Was it clear what the system was doing?

Q4



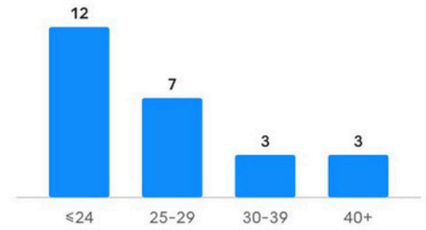
How did the chatbot's tone feel?

Q10



Participants by age

years



First-time renters understood less



The renters who need the explanations most understood them least.

Problems confirmed by more than one method

Issues	**Walkthrough**	Expert review	**Usability test**	**Survey**
Landlord email fails	Not testable locally	–	3 of 4 failed	3 say email not working
Waiting during upload	Progress on a timer	No cancel (major)	–	36% wait not fully OK
Deposit clause and card	Yellow vs red	Yellow implies warning (major)	2 of 4 failed	1 wording confusing
Too much information	–	4 design (H8) issues	2 of 4 overwhelmed	3 want simpler UI
Trust	–	Few trust sections	1 hesitated at start	3 want official sources
Risk colours	Hover not obvious (major)	Count not coloured	Not seen: 4 of 4 passed	–

What we will change

1	Make the landlord email reliable: a fallback draft and a clear error message instead of endless loading.
2	Let the upload run in the background, or be cancelled.
3	Show deposit facts in a neutral colour and simplify the clause wording
4	Show fewer general clauses so the risky ones stand out.
5	Link explanations to official RTB guidance to build trust, especially for first-time renters.

Hypothesis largely supported

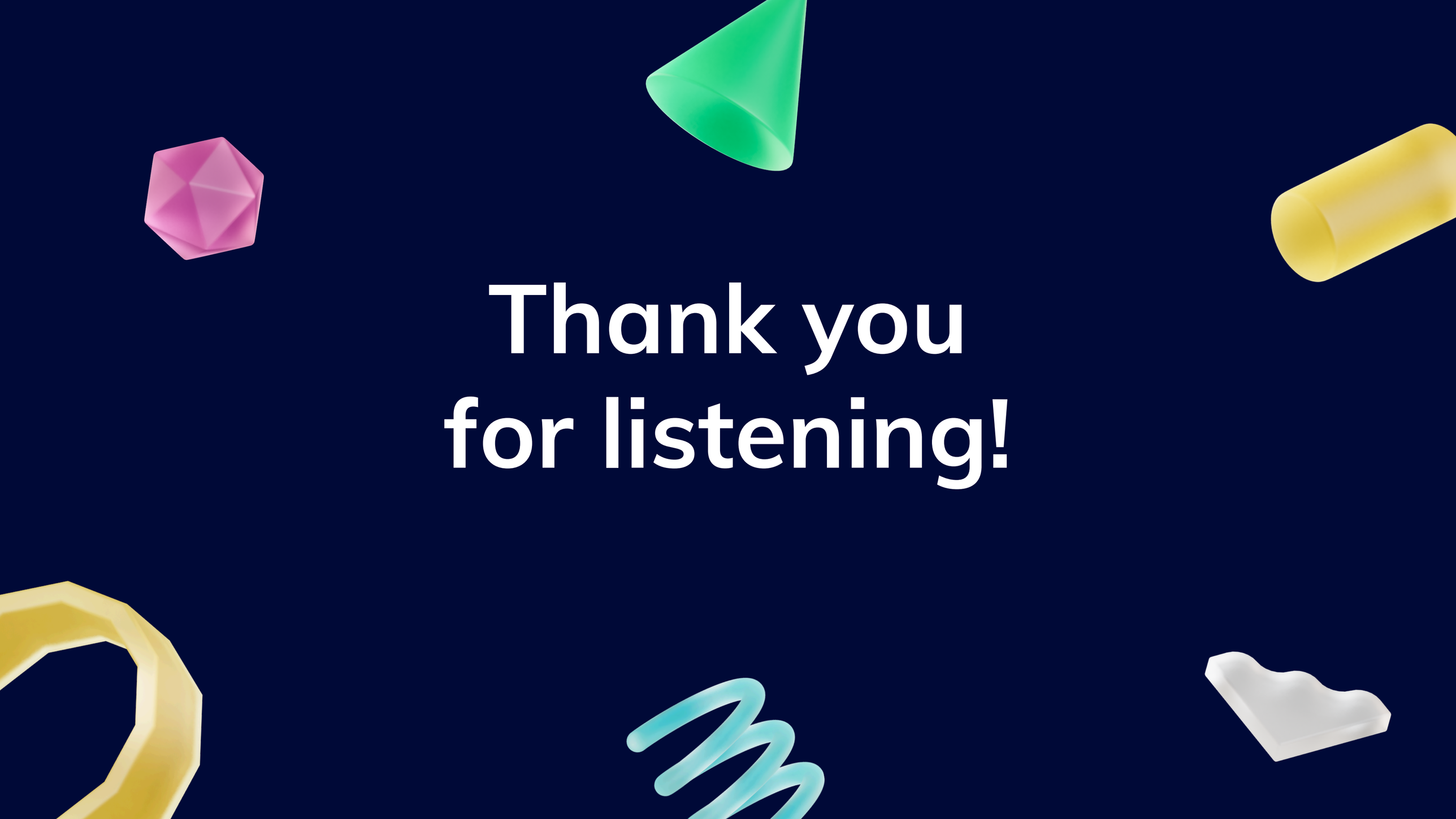
75% of tasks done with no help, every test participant made the right signing decision, explanations rated 4.6 of 5, and 84% would use ClauseGuard.

Not yet for everyone: the email feature failed, waits frustrated a third, and first-time renters understood less.

Next study

- Compare the lease alone with ClauseGuard
- Test 5–8 people, more on phones
- Use unseen leases, not only the sample
- Add the standard questionnaire

Include a housing-law expert, e.g. Threshold


Thank you
for listening!